GAMESFORUM INTELLIGENCE

MOBILE GAMING BY GENRE: HYPERCASUAL

A Marketing and Monetization Report

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INTRODUCTION

The hypercasual genre is far from disappearing, instead, it is transforming. While perceptions of decline persist, our exploration of the current data shows strong performance in both user acquisition and monetization. In H1 2025, the top 100 hypercasual games recorded 2.4 billion downloads and $345 million in IAP revenue, setting the stage for the genre's most lucrative year to date. As developers adapt to higher UA costs and shifting player expectations, many are evolving their titles into hybrid-casual formats - retaining accessible gameplay while layering in deeper progression and monetization.

This report explores how leading studios are navigating that shift, supported by case studies, market breakdowns, and forward-looking analysis.

What's Inside the Report

- A breakdown of the top hypercasual publishers and titles from 2019 to 2025
- Case studies on hybrid-casual success stories including Mob Control, Color Block Jam, and Pizza Ready
- Insights into monetization models, creative testing strategies, and global market trends

Together, these insights present a clear view of how hypercasual continues to drive scale, experimentation, and innovation in mobile gaming.

HYPERCASUAL GENRE REPORT OVERVIEW

Top Hypercasual Publishers

In the first six months of 2025, the top 100 hypercasual titles have amassed 5.484 billion global downloads across both the Google Play Store and iOS AppStore.

Following a growing trend of revenue diversification to reduce reliance on one stream, 2025 so far has also seen 379 million USD generated in IAP revenue from the top 100 hypercasual publishers. H1 of 2025 has far surpassed previous annual IAP revenue for hypercasual titles.

In the table below you can view the top ten hypercasual publishers in H1 of 2025 by downloads across their hypercasual tagged titles.

	Top Free	Downloads
1	AZUR GAMES Cyprus	609,465,701
2	Supersonic Studios LTD Israel	372,262,506
3	VOODOO France	362,506,746
4	SayGames Ltd Cyprus	335,220,183
5	Supercent, Inc. South Korea	242,112,533
6	ABI Games Studio Vietnam	207,415,514
7	CrazyLabs LTD Israel	168,215,484
8	Homa France	161,881,530
9	Freeplay Inc United States	160,467,883
10	iKame Games - Zego Studio Vietnam	147,430,677

HYPERCASUAL GENRE REPORT OVERVIEW

AZUR GAMES ranks first with an impressive 609 million downloads in the first six months of 2025, achieving 237 million more downloads than **Super Sonic Studios LTD,** which is in second place with 372 million downloads.

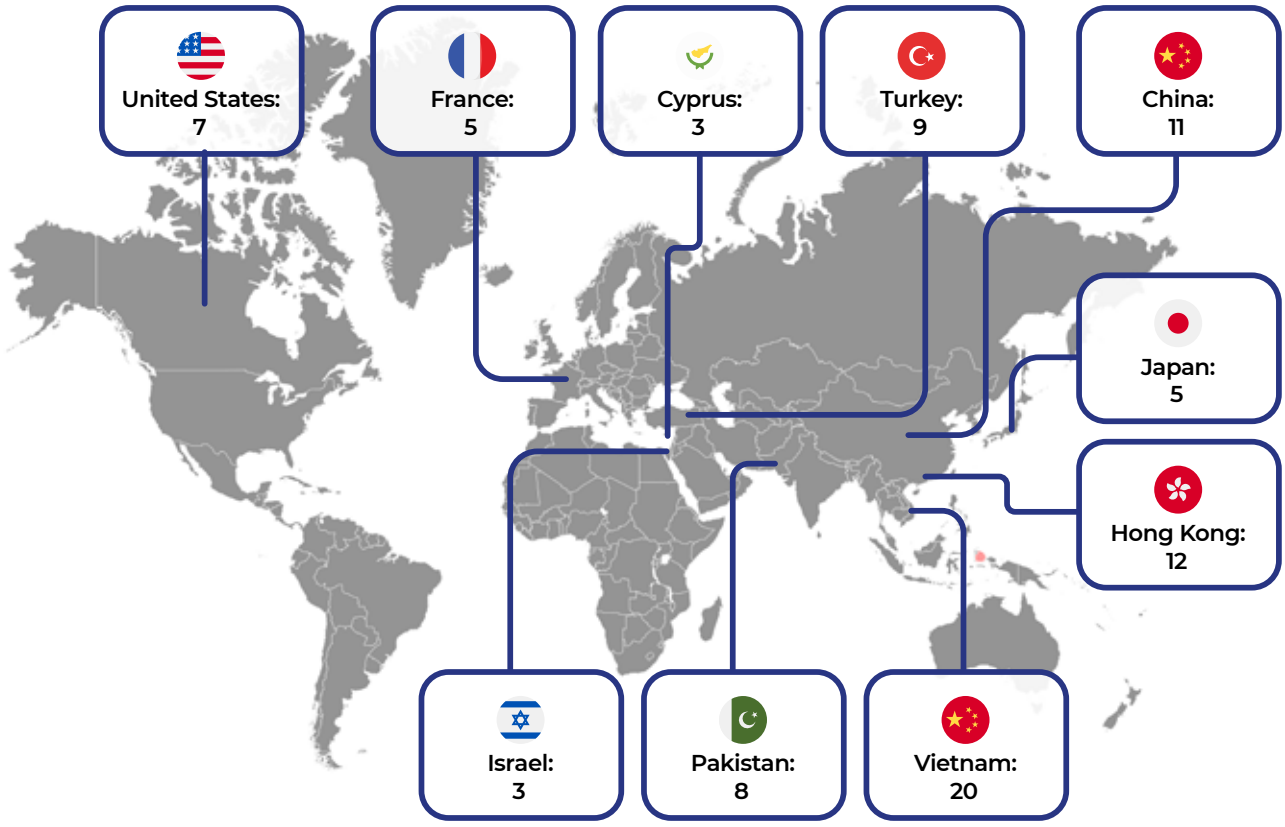
Voodoo places third with 362 million downloads and **SayGames Ltd** in fourth with 335 million downloads before **Supercent, Inc.** in fifth, with 242 million downloads.

As covered in our Cyprus industry report, the small island is a powerhouse of mobile publishing success, hosting numerous top hypercasual, casual and midcore mobile game publishers.

Other countries are also highlighted in our top ten hypercasual publishers for 2025 so far. France, Israel and Vietnam all host two of the most successful hypercasual publishers.

Looking further down the list of the top 100 hypercasual publishers of 2025, you can see incredible success coming out of APAC - Vietnam in particular is home to one fifth of the top hypercasual publishers.

Of the top 100 hypercasual publishers in H1 of 2025, they are headquartered in:



HYPERCASUAL GENRE REPORT OVERVIEW

The Hypercasual Publisher Portfolios

Below you can find a deeper look at our top ten hypercasual publishers of H1 2025, including their hypercasual game portfolio size, primary audiences, and the countries they operate in.

All data is collected via AppMagic, looking at each publisher's catalogue games tagged as hypercasual, this includes both live and sunset games.

AZUR GAMES

Of the 554 apps listed on AppMagic, AZUR GAMES has taken ownership over 273 hypercasual titles, with the first launching in February 2016 and three launching so far in 2025.

Closing in on 12 billion lifetime downloads, 16% of AZUR GAMES downloads are from India with a further 10% from the United States, 8% from Brazil and 7% from Russia.

31 of the publisher's games have received over one-million downloads in the last 30 days with the most successful title Worms Zone.io, and Hungry Snake achieving 6.9-million in the last 30 days with over 550-million in lifetime downloads.

As is usually the case with hypercasual publishers, a majority of revenue comes from ads, however AZUR GAMES' IAP revenue peaked in May 2025 at 5.6 million USD. For the first time in the publisher's history, IAP revenue has averaged above 5 million USD per month through 2025 so far, compared to an average of 2.5 million USD per month through 2022 and 2023.

In its lifetime, AZUR GAMES has amassed 308 million USD in IAP revenue. More than a third of lifetime IAP revenue comes from the United States at 112 million USD, with Russia, Germany, UK, Japan and South Korea each contributing 4% to lifetime IAP revenue.

Supersonic Studios Ltd.

Placing second as the greatest hypercasual publisher in terms of downloads, Supersonic Studios Ltd has 372 million downloads in the first six months of 2025.

Like AZUR GAMES, a majority of its lifetime downloads come from India, with 19%, or 966 million downloads, followed by the United States at 530 million downloads. Supersonic Studios Ltd. has amassed a lifetime download total of 5.2 billion with a portfolio of 122 hypercasual titles, the first launching in 2019 with three more released in 2025 so far.

Supersonic Studios Ltd. has also seen an uptick in IAP revenue generated through 2024 and 2025, achieving over 1 million USD in September 2024 and January 2025. With a lifetime IAP revenue of 25 million USD, a total of 34% comes from the United States.

Voodoo

With 8.4 billion lifetime downloads and 362 million in 2025 so far, French publisher Voodoo placed third in our top hypercasual publishers of H1 2025.

Breaking the trend of core geos, 19% of Voodoo's lifetime downloads come from the United States at 1.6 billion total, with a further 938 million from India.

With a portfolio of 280 hypercasual titles, Hole.io and Paper.io 2 have amassed over 10.5 million downloads in the last 30 days, with a further 11 titles achieving more than a million downloads in the last month.

Voodoo has been open about its embracing of hybrid monetization and its increasing focus on IAP revenue alongside its long successful ad revenue. In March 2023, Voodoo reported a 2.7x increase in its IAP revenue and a 10x increase in its IAP ARPDAU since January 2022.

Since this announcement in March 2023, Voodoo's IAP revenue has continued to grow, averaging 9.85 million USD monthly in Q4 of 2024, with a lifetime IAP revenue of 258 million USD.

SayGames Ltd.

The second Cyprus-based publisher, placing fourth with 335 million downloads in 2025 H1, is SayGames Ltd.

With a portfolio of 119 hypercasual titles, SayGames Ltd. has achieved over 6 billion lifetime downloads, with 16% from India and 11% from the United States. Releasing its first title in 2017, the company has released two new titles in 2025 so far.

Looking at the IAP revenue, SayGames has also seen an uplift in spenders, with its hypercasual titles consistently achieving over 5 million USD in monthly IAP revenue since June 2024. There has been a concentrated effort on its top performing titles with Tower War - Tactical Conquest, My Perfect Hotel and Squad Alpha - Action Shooting, with each achieving over 20 million USD in lifetime IAP revenue.

Supercent Inc.

South Korean publisher Supercent Inc ranked fifth in downloads for H1 of 2025, with 242 million downloads.

With 119 titles listed on AppMagic under Supercent Inc, the company's hypercasual portfolio has achieved over 1 billion lifetime downloads. 15% of its downloads are attributed to India, with a further 9% from the United States and 7% from Brazil.

Having released its first title in 2021, Supercent Inc has continued to launch titles through 2025, with four new games between January and May. Its most successful title, Pizza Ready! has received 263 million lifetime downloads and over 14.5 million downloads in the last 30 days.

Taking a look at revenue, Supercent, Inc has maintained a focus on ad revenue, with IAP revenue at 16 million USD during the publisher's lifetime.

HYPERCASUAL GENRE REPORT OVERVIEW

Top Hypercasual Apps in Numbers

In the table and graphs below you can see how the top 100 hypercasual games have performed year-on-year from 2019 to 2024, including a forecast for 2025.

Year	Annual Hypercasual Downloads	Annual Hypercasual IAP Revenue
2019	5,446,523,668	130,995,496
2020	7,064,752,300	107,177,496
2021	5,948,747,293	110,604,150
2022	4,960,890,658	111,137,497
2023	4,443,195,477	192,723,934
2024	4,734,015,371	403,833,377
2025 (FC)*	4,818,721,844	690,012,732
2025 (H1)	2,409,360,922	345,006,366

***FC is a forecast for 2025 annual numbers based on the current hypercasual download and IAP revenue for H1 of 2025 multiplied by two to reflect an identical performance in H2. This does not factor in the expected uptick in both IAP revenue and downloads for Q4 of 2025, so estimates are conservative.**

The above table depicts in real numbers download trends in hypercasual games from the height of 2019 and 2020 through to the low of 2023 and its gradual return to an upward trajectory through 2024, as well as an estimation for 2025.

2022 and 2023 saw the introduction of the phrase hybrid-casual, with more hypercasual publishers focusing on revenue diversification in a turbulent UA landscape, which saw CPIs rising and privacy depreciation alongside the end of the pandemic changing an era of player behaviour.

In terms of revenue, the trends from 2019 to 2024, and a forecast for 2025, further show a wider embrace of IAP revenue in hypercasual games, further mixing the monetization models and increasing the players' opportunity to spend alongside the traditional ad revenue.

HYPERCASUAL GENRE REPORT OVERVIEW

Hypercasual Downloads Year-on-Year

The below figure further demonstrates download trends from 2019 to 2024, including a forecast for 2025.

As shown, the 2020 peak saw annual downloads for the top 100 most downloaded hypercasual games reach over 7 billion, followed by a year-on-year decline of 1 billion downloads through 2021 and 2022, before reaching a low of 4.4 billion downloads in 2023.

This can be attributed to player behaviour post-pandemic, with people returning to work and having less free time to play mobile games, coupled with the depreciation of privacy, with Apple's IDFA, and the impact on CPI's, UA budgets and ad revenue value. A true concoction of challenges that ultimately made it harder to release and market games.

In 2024, the number of annual downloads across the top performing titles increased by just short of 300 million, with a conservative estimate of an increase again in 2025 by 85 million downloads to 4.8 billion annual downloads across the top performing games.

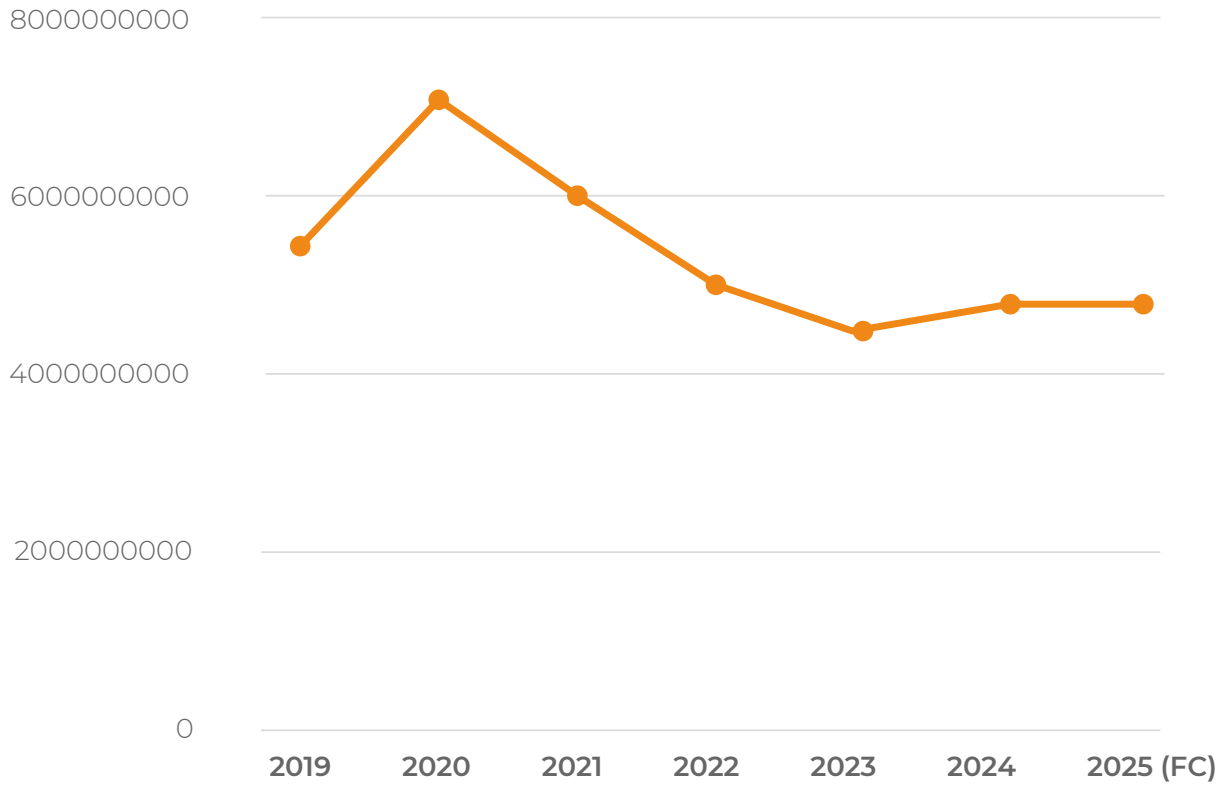


Figure 2: The annual combined IAP revenue of the top 100 performing mobile games from 2019 to 2024, with an estimate for 2025.

Hypercasual IAP Revenue Year-on-Year

Graph two contains the annual combined IAP revenue of the top 100 performing mobile games from 2019 through 2024, with an estimate for 2025. The estimate does not account for the normative Q4 uptick in IAP revenue.

In the graph, you can see a slight decline in 2019 to 2020, with IAP revenue moving from 130 million USD to 107 million USD between the two years, before remaining stable at 110 million USD in 2021, and 111 million USD in 2022.

As commented above, 2022 marked a turning point with more hypercasual publishers focusing on diversifying their revenue and welcoming more opportunities for players to pay in their titles. This can clearly be seen in 2023 with IAP revenue across the top performing hypercasual titles increasing by 80 million, to 192 million USD in 2023.

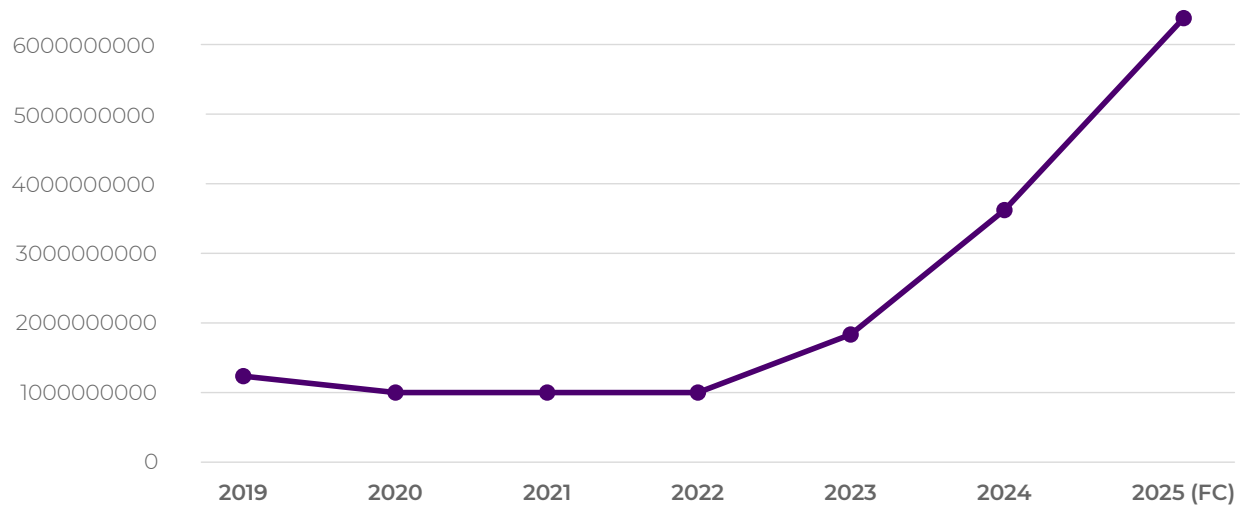


Figure 3 shows a projected $690 million in IAP revenue for 2025 across the top 100 hypercasual titles. This is based on H1 performance of $345 million, doubled to estimate full-year results. This marks a significant surge in in-app purchasing within the genre.

This upward trend continues in 2024, with a further 220 million USD being added across the top performing hypercasual games totaling 403 million USD in IAP revenue for 2024.

The 2025 estimate, as mentioned, is based on H1 performance for the top 100 titles being doubled to reflect an identical performance in H2. The H1 performance signals a huge year for IAP revenue in hypercasual titles, with 345 million USD generated across the top 100 games.

When doubled, this provides an estimated forecast of 690 million USD for the year 2025 across the top 100 hypercasual games by IAP revenue, in what would be an incredible bolstering of in-app purchasing amongst players.

WHY HYPERCASUAL MATTERS IN 2025

Hypercasual games are undergoing a shift, with the evolution now often tilting towards hybrid-casual, which introduces deeper monetization strategies and increased complexity. As the data before this section shows, however, hypercasual's ultra-light builds and rapid development cycles allow studios to quickly test new gameplay concepts and advertising strategies, an increasingly important advantage in today's fast-paced market.

In the next section of this report, we analyse how leading publishers are transitioning toward hybrid-casual models in 2025, identify the key factors still driving success in hypercasual, present case studies of some of the top-performing hybrid-casual games, and what we can learn from them.

WHAT ACTUALLY MAKES A HYPERCASUAL GAME SUCCESSFUL?

Hypercasual games succeed by distilling gameplay to one ultra-simple mechanic and loop. There is almost no tutorial or complexity – just a single addictive gesture (tap, swipe, drag, stack, etc.) that anyone can learn instantly. The genre's breakthrough hit Flappy Bird (2013) epitomised this philosophy – simple one-touch gameplay, endless times to retry, and mass appeal. In practice this means very short play sessions (often 30–60 seconds per attempt) and no complex meta-systems. The core loop must be immediately fun and intuitive, so players "click in" and feel compelled to play again seconds later.

Rapid development and iteration are key to hypercasual success. Top publishers often prototype games in a matter of days or weeks. The development cycle remains remarkably fast compared to other genres: a basic game concept is built and immediately tested in the market. If metrics look promising, the team quickly polishes and scales it; if not, they kill it and move to the next idea. This rapid prototype-to-publish timeline (sometimes just 4–8 weeks from concept to launch) allows hypercasual portfolios to stay fresh and chase the latest trends or meme-inspired concepts.

Data-driven iteration and testing underpin this process. Critical KPIs that determine a hypercasual game's fate include: Cost Per Install, Day-1 and Day-7 retention, and Lifetime Value per user. Success in hypercasual is often a simple equation – can you acquire users cheaply enough (low CPI) and keep them engaged long enough (decent retention) to earn more from them in ad revenue than you spent? CPI is arguably the king metric. These games operate on razor-thin margins with ad monetization, so user acquisition cost must be extraordinarily low.

Retention is the counterbalance: even ultra-casual players should stick around for a few days if the game is good. A Day-1 retention around 40% or higher is a common benchmark for a promising game, whereas anything below ~30% on Day 1 likely indicates weak appeal. By Day 7, retention often drops to single digits in this genre – top performers might hit ~15% D7, but many hypercasual games see <10% by Day 7.

This steep drop-off is expected; **the key is having enough volume of downloads and ad impressions before players churn out.**

WHAT ACTUALLY MAKES A HYPERCASUAL GAME SUCCESSFUL?

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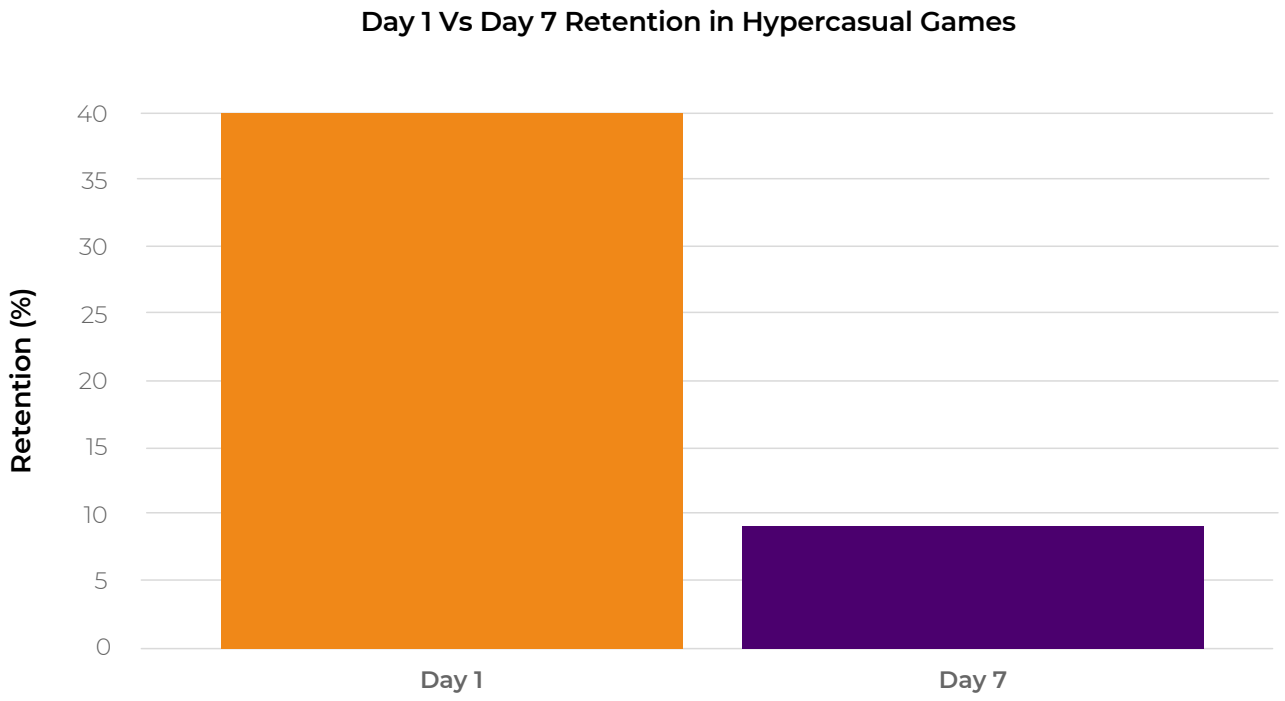
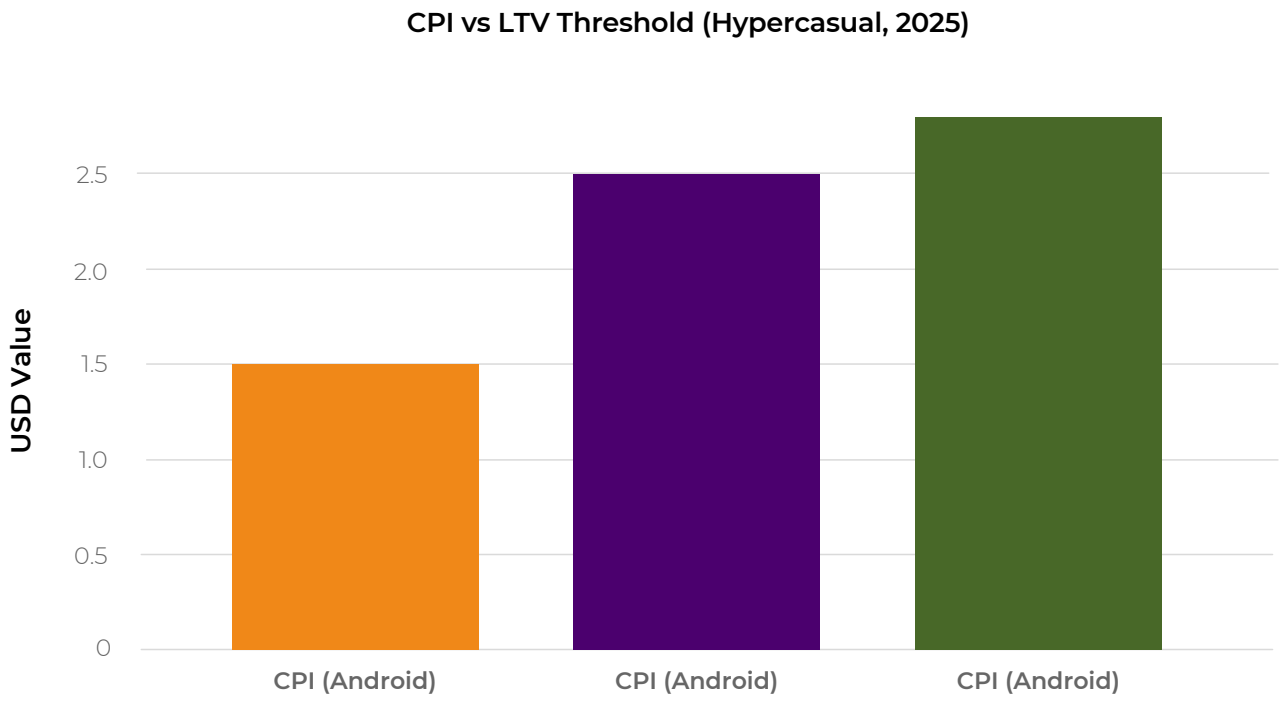


SolarEngine's data-driven guide notes that average Day 1 retention for hypercasual games is under 25%, with Day 7 retention dropping below 8%.

Because individual user LTV is so low (often only a few cents or a few ad views), scale and volume are everything. Hypercasual is a hits-driven, mass-market business model – it's about getting tens of millions of downloads and monetizing each through ads. For context, one of the biggest hypercasual hits, Voodoo's Helix Jump, generated over 500 million downloads yet made only about $2.8 million from in-app purchases. The vast majority of its revenue came from ads shown to that huge player base. This means LTV per user is almost entirely ad-driven, and often well under $1. Thus, to be profitable, CPI must be lower than LTV, which in practice means targeting CPIs of a few dimes or less in key markets. In short, a successful hypercasual title needs to acquire users extremely cheaply, hook them for just long enough, and show enough ads per user to recoup and profit.

WHAT ACTUALLY MAKES A HYPERCASUAL GAME SUCCESSFUL?



CPI vs. LTV Threshold for Hypercasual Games (2025)

This figure compares average CPI ($1.50 Android, $2.50 iOS) with an estimated LTV of $2.80, underscoring the thin margins in hypercasual UA. Maintaining CPI below LTV is essential for profitability and scale. Data: Mapendo, Exscape.

Creative testing via ads has become a cornerstone of finding "the next big hit." Rather than building a full game and hoping it clicks, hypercasual studios invert the process: they test the market first with advertising. This often involves making a short gameplay video or playable ad of the concept (even before the game is fully functional) and running it on platforms like Facebook, Instagram, or TikTok to gauge interest. The metrics from these campaigns – especially the click-through rate (CTR) and cost per click – act as early indicators of CPI. If an ad for the idea attracts a high CTR (meaning users are intrigued and clicking), it usually foreshadows a low CPI and strong demand. If the CTR or install rate is poor, the concept is likely scrapped.

WHAT ACTUALLY MAKES A HYPERCASUAL GAME SUCCESSFUL?

Finally, user acquisition strategy and creative optimisation are make-or-break factors tied to success. Hypercasual UA teams are relentless in optimising ad creatives – trying different videos, playables, angles, and trends to find an ad that yields the lowest CPI. Often, the gameplay itself is tweaked to better fit high-performing ad concepts (a peculiar inversion where the ad creative feedback influences the game design!). The importance of creative is huge: a well-crafted playable ad can achieve extremely high engagement and CTR – In essence, hypercasual success isn't just about a fun core mechanic – it's about packaging that mechanic in a way that grabs attention in a 15-second ad and converts scrollers into downloaders.

THE SHIFT TO HYBRID-CASUAL

The boundary between hypercasual and hybrid-casual games is fading. Leading hypercasual titles are increasingly incorporating light meta-progression - such as levels, upgrades, or cosmetic customisation, to extend retention beyond short sessions. Hybrid-casual games still rely on simple, accessible core mechanics but add engagement layers to keep users for weeks instead of minutes.

As Unity notes, hybrid-casual design aims to retain players for 60–90 days, boosting both retention and LTV. Some studios convert successful hypercasual prototypes into hybrid variants by adding meta features once Day-7 retention reaches 5–10%.

In other words, the **evolution is additive**. All of the ultra-simple, fast-moving strategies above still apply, but developers might introduce mild progression (daily tasks, hero skins, light IAP) to eke out more revenue per user. This hybrid approach can raise average retention into the teens of percent by Day 7, making the game more sustainable with slightly higher UA budgets. As one report notes, the industry is seeing "a shift from hyper-casual to hybrid-casual games" where ad-based models are supplemented by IAP.

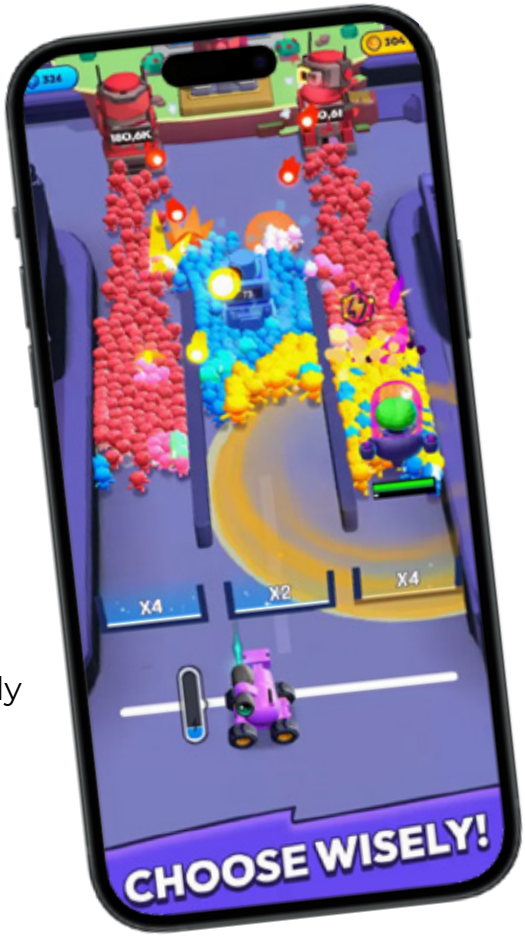
CASE STUDIES: SUCCESSFULLY EVOLVING FROM HYPERCASUAL TO HYBRID-CASUAL

Several studios have navigated the transition from hypercasual to hybrid casual by leveraging existing user acquisition channels while introducing deeper gameplay loops and monetization models.

These pivots succeeded by aligning design, monetization, and UA strategies around longer player engagement cycles without abandoning the low-CPI discovery model of hypercasual.

We explore some of the most popular examples in our case studies below.

CASE STUDY 1: VOODOO'S MOB CONTROL



Voodoo long built its reputation on simple hyper-casual games, but in recent years the company strategically pivoted to deeper, hybrid-casual titles. One prime example is Mob Control (released in 2021), which combines a minimalist tower-defense loop with long-term meta-progression. As Voodoo's internal case study notes, "after years of pioneering hyper-casual, the company...set its sights on making casual mobile games with deeper metas", and this shift paid off: Mob Control has already surpassed a $200M annual run-rate.

In industry terms, Mob Control blends a hyper-casual core (easy to pick up) with addictive meta-elements, making it a textbook hybrid-casual success.

CASE STUDIES: SUCCESSFULLY EVOLVING FROM HYPERCASUAL TO HYBRID-CASUAL

A VOODOO MONETIZATION LESSON IN PIVOTING TO HYBRID-CASUAL WITH BAPTISTE DURIF

HEAD OF AD MONETIZATION, **VOODOO**

At Voodoo, we made the progressive strategic shift from hypercasual toward hybrid-casual games in 2021/2022. This decision was influenced by key market signals, including rapidly rising user acquisition costs and declining monetization efficiency within the traditional hypercasual segment.

Simultaneously, we observed a notable trend: hybrid casual games, with their richer gameplay mechanics, retained users longer and significantly boosted lifetime value. This allowed us to better offset higher acquisition costs and maximize our return on ad spend. Essentially, hybrid-casual games presented a sustainable pathway by combining the engagement depth of mid-core gameplay with the accessibility and monetization agility of hypercasual models.

Our most effective monetization strategies for hybrid-casual games at Voodoo revolve around a carefully balanced mix of rewarded video ads, targeted in-app purchases, and strategically placed interstitial ads. Rewarded videos have proven particularly successful, offering players clear in-game advantages like power-ups, currency boosts, or progression aids in exchange for voluntary engagement with ads. This approach seamlessly integrates monetization into the gameplay loop, enhancing rather than disrupting player experience and thus driving higher retention and LTV.

However, we also maintain selective use of interstitial ads, strategically placed at natural break points within the game to generate incremental revenue without negatively impacting the overall user experience. By continuously analysing user behavior and engagement data, we optimize the frequency and placement of these interstitials, ensuring minimal disruption while maximising monetization efficiency.

On the in-app purchase side, we carefully identify player segments inclined towards premium experiences and strategically present them with meaningful purchase opportunities. Overall, by conducting constant A/B testing across all monetization methods, our target is to ensure that each player segment receives an optimal balance of monetization methods.

CASE STUDIES: SUCCESSFULLY EVOLVING FROM HYPERCASUAL TO HYBRID-CASUAL

WHAT MAKES MOB CONTROL SUCCESSFUL?

UA Strategy

Mob Control's UA approach was highly data-driven. Voodoo set ambitious ROI goals – for example, a 4-month target of **150% ROAS** – and Mob Control quickly exceeded it (reaching ~160%). The team deliberately balanced scale with profit: they kept ad campaigns optimised for profitability rather than just installs. In practice this meant continuous A/B tests and tuning of the ad funnel. For example, Voodoo increased rewarded video slots and cut back on interstitial ads, which led to higher overall playtime and retention. They also fine-tuned by region: in India (Mob Control's #2 market by DAU) "skip" ads proved ineffective, so they leaned more on direct currency IAP offers for those users.

Mob Control's UA was about constant iteration – dozens of ad variants tested weekly, and aligning ad strategy with both global KPI targets and local user behaviour.

Creative (Ads and Marketing)

Voodoo supported Mob Control's UA with a massive creative output. The team reported producing 300–500 distinct ad creatives per week for Mob Control. These included gameplay videos, cartoon animations, and even user-generated-style clips, tailored to each platform. Recent analytics show over 500 unique Facebook/Meta ads and more than 100 on AppLovin running simultaneously.

They varied formats – short 15-30s videos on Meta, longer clips on YouTube, to match channel norms. This data-driven creative testing kept the user feed fresh and allowed the team to quickly learn which hooks worked (e.g. showing army multipliers vs. champion characters). In short, Mob Control's marketing leaned on quantity and variety of ads, with each creative A/B-tested across networks, ensuring broad reach and continual optimisation.

CASE STUDIES: SUCCESSFULLY EVOLVING FROM HYPERCASUAL TO HYBRID-CASUAL

WHAT CAN WE LEARN?

Marketing & Timing: Voodoo leveraged high-visibility campaigns and IP tie-ins to broaden appeal. For example, in 2023 Mob Control ran a Transformers crossover event (featuring Bumblebee) tied to the brand's 40th anniversary. This tapped into nostalgia and brought in new players, even though branded creatives came with higher CPI. Timing such events with cultural moments (movie releases, anniversaries, holidays) kept the game in the spotlight. At the same time, Voodoo never sacrificed ROI: its lead UA manager explicitly targets profitability, not just installs.

Innovative Mechanics: The team kept evolving the game itself. Early on they revamped the core tower-building mechanic to reduce monotony – a change that boosted lifetime value by about 20%. Social and competitive layers were added as well: Voodoo rolled out clan features and PvP base-defense modes (with ~50 active clans even before official launch) to encourage community play. These hybrid elements: layering strategy and progression on top of the simple core loop, turned Mob Control into an engaging live service.

Why it Succeeded: Mob Control perfectly embodies a hybrid-casual model: **a simple, addictive core** loop supplemented by deeper meta gameplay. It achieved strong retention (reported ~15% D7) by giving players both quick battles and long-term goals (upgrades, events, clans). It surpassed the $200M annual run-rate barrier and is still climbing.

Crucially, Voodoo's culture of "prototype fast, kill fast, then scale what works" meant they kept polishing Mob Control over years instead of treating it as a one-off hyper-casual title.

CASE STUDIES: SUCCESSFULLY EVOLVING FROM HYPERCASUAL TO HYBRID-CASUAL

FINAL TAKEAWAYS

The Mob Control case highlights the power of adaptive strategy in mobile games. Voodoo recognised market shifts (e.g. rising ad costs after Apple's IDFA changes) and pivoted from pure hypercasual to hybrid-casual titles.

The lessons for developers are clear: invest in UX (so new players onboard easily), build meta-progression (to retain players long-term), and support your game with relentless data-driven UA and creative testing. And critically, balance growth with profitability – Mob Control's team always emphasised sustainable ROAS over reckless scaling.

By combining strong UX, continuous innovation, and savvy marketing, Mob Control became a breakout success in the hybrid-casual space.

CASE STUDY 2: COLOR BLOCK JAM

In Q1 2025 alone, Color Block Jam saw about 18.9 million downloads globally reflecting its rapid rise. This wide reach across iOS and Android propelled it into the Top Free charts (e.g. #4 Free Puzzle on Google Play as of mid-2025). Such massive adoption laid the foundation for its blockbuster revenue performance, making it one of Rollic's fastest-scaling hits.

DID YOU KNOW?

Color Block Jam's most effective ad campaign used a psychological trick called the Zeigarnik effect. By cutting off gameplay videos just before the final puzzle move, viewers felt compelled to download the game just to finish the level themselves. This tactic helped drive over 17.5 million downloads in just three months.

CASE STUDIES: SUCCESSFULLY EVOLVING FROM HYPERCASUAL TO HYBRID-CASUAL

WHAT MAKES COLOR BLOCK JAM SUCCESSFUL?

UX/UI design: Color Block Jam's user experience is crafted for accessibility and satisfaction. Visually, it employs a clean, colorful layout with block pieces that resemble LEGO bricks, leveraging their universal familiarity to make the game instantly relatable.

Indeed, engaged players were clocking exceptionally high play times (e.g. nearly 167 minutes by Day 7 on average), reflecting how the polished UX/UI keeps people hooked.

UA strategy and creative: Color Block Jam's global success was driven by a deliberate, high-budget UA strategy. Rollic ran aggressive campaigns across social media and ad networks, but it was their creative execution that delivered impact.

They addressed user fatigue with mobile ads by marketing the game as a "no ads" experience, using on-screen text and voice overs. Though only partially accurate, this messaging resonated and increased conversion.

By combining incomplete but compelling gameplay clips, ASMR-like audio, clean visuals, and relatable hooks, Rollic's ads generated over 17.5 million installs and more than $23 million in revenue within three months, propelling Color Block Jam to the top of global charts.

CASE STUDIES: SUCCESSFULLY EVOLVING FROM HYPERCASUAL TO HYBRID-CASUAL

WHAT CAN WE LEARN?

Color Block Jam uses a three-stage monetization funnel to maximise revenue without harming player experience.

Stage 1 – No Ads: New players enjoy a long ad-free "honeymoon" period, building engagement. Early monetization comes from gentle IAP offers like the "Failed Level Pack" after tough levels.

Stage 2 – Light Ads: Banner ads begin to appear, and IAP prompts become more frequent. These serve as soft nudges toward spending or tolerating minor ad interruptions.

Stage 3 – Full Ads: Deeply engaged non-payers see interstitials after every level, while rewarded videos offer optional value (e.g. double coins). Ads are delayed until level ~15 to avoid early churn.

On the IAP side, the game sells boosters, extra time, and premium tools like the Color Vacuum, designed to address real in-game pain points. Packs are priced for accessibility, encouraging impulse buys.

This model helped drive peak revenues of over $250,000/day, showing how timed ad introduction + meaningful IAPs can power hybrid monetization at scale.

Market timing and appeal: Color Block Jam launched at the perfect moment - late 2024, just as block puzzle games surged, contributing 71% of puzzle game revenue in early 2025. Players were seeking games deeper than hypercasuals but with easy onboarding. Rollic hit this hybrid-casual sweet spot.

With few direct competitors blending timed puzzles and monetization depth, Color Block Jam quickly stood out. By January 2025, it generated nearly 4× the revenue of its next closest puzzle rival, establishing dominance in the hybrid-puzzle category.

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Innovative mechanics: Color Block Jam stood out by adding a timer to every puzzle, turning calm gameplay into a fast-paced, arcade-style challenge. This time pressure, combined with rising complexity, created a unique and monetizable tension, players often used boosters or retries to beat the clock.

A signature power-up, the "Color Vacuum", clears all blocks of one color in a dramatic burst. It adds strategy and visual flair, offering a satisfying board-clearing moment that's rare in block games.

The game also introduced fresh puzzle elements over time, like teleporters, moving barriers, and "Moving Crates", keeping the experience dynamic. Levels were carefully designed to feel just solvable, rewarding pattern recognition and near-miss retries.

FINAL TAKEAWAYS

Critically, CBJ's success owes to its hybrid-casual design. It starts like a simple hyper-casual block slider but gradually layers in depth: players enjoy an initial ad-free "honeymoon" and light tutorial, then face tougher puzzles with targeted ads and IAP offers along the way.

Rollic built in boosters (e.g. extra time, bombs, "fail-level" packs) and optional ads-for-coins, plus seasonal events and a battle pass, to reward longer play. This mix of mechanics drives strong retention (industry observers report CBJ hitting ~20% Day-7 and ~10% Day-30 retention – far above typical hyper-casual levels) and higher per-user revenue. As one analysis noted, CBJ "blends ads + in-apps" while keeping the UI minimal and puzzles satisfying. The line between hyper-casual and "full" casual is indeed blurring – CBJ's hybrid approach has earned $43M+ lifetime (33M downloads) – and it now rivals big puzzle titles in sustained earnings.

But with its rapid growth, rich live-ops content and smart monetization design, Color Block Jam demonstrates how a hyper-casual puzzle can successfully pivot into a long-lived hybrid hit.

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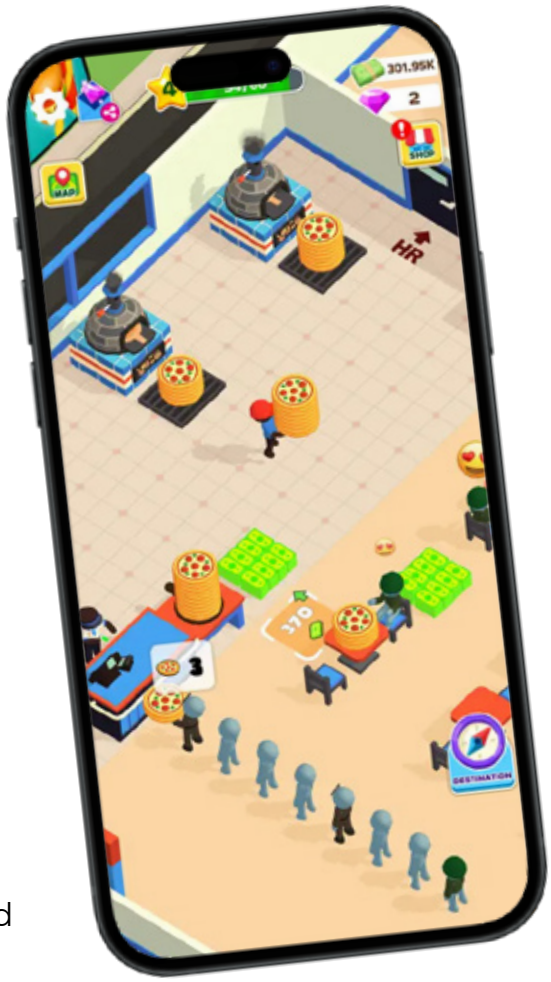

CASE STUDY 3: SUPERCENT'S PIZZA READY

Pizza Ready's success exemplifies the mobile industry's shift to hybrid-casual games – titles that combine the mass appeal and accessible mechanics of hyper-casual games with deeper gameplay loops and balanced economies. Supercent initially built simple hyper-casual hits but pivoted to hybrid-casual development; its games Pizza Ready and Outlets Rush are now called "hybrid-casual gold," with roughly 70% of revenue from ads and 30% from in-app purchases. This mixed monetization approach aligns with the hybrid-casual model and helped Pizza Ready gain rapid traction after launch.

UA strategy and creative: Supercent clearly invested in aggressive user acquisition to propel Pizza Ready. Industry analyses (and Supercent's own statements) suggest the team constantly monitors competitor ads and iterates their own creatives. For example, Supercent mixes quick video ads and playable ads in marketing, letting videos grab attention immediately while playables let prospects try a mini-challenge. They also emphasise strong first impressions – focusing on the first few seconds of an ad – to hook viewers, as noted by Supercent's blog. The results were immediate: Pizza Ready shot up the download charts worldwide right after launch. Chart trackers show it hit as high as #2 globally among all games (not just simulations).

Behind the scenes, Supercent refined campaigns at the "sub-source" level: adjusting spend and creatives for each ad network and country for optimal CPI and retention. They even tap smaller networks and influencers to broaden reach cost-effectively. In short, Pizza Ready's UA blended high-volume marketing (top chart ranks) with data-driven fine-tuning: sourcing inspiration from competitors and tweaking each ad channel for maximum ROI.

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MONETIZATION: ADS AND PURCHASES

- **Frequent rewarded videos:** Almost every boost or critical upgrade can be obtained by watching a video. This keeps the in-game economy fast-paced (tasks would otherwise take much longer) and maximises ad impressions.

- **Bundled IAPs:** New updates added premium bundles and passes (think "extra everything" pizza packs) built right into gameplay. Despite heavy ad use, dedicated players spent significantly on these extras – Pizza Ready earned about $345K from IAPs in 30 days in one analysis.

- **Hybrid revenue mix:** Roughly 70% of the game's revenue comes from ads and 30% from purchases. In practice, Pizza Ready emphasises rewarded videos and incentivised offers rather than intrusive banners, aligning with the hybrid-casual trend.

MARKET TIMING AND APPEAL

Pizza Ready's theme and timing helped it reach a massive audience. Cooking and restaurant games have universal appeal, and pizza is especially familiar. Notably, 23% of the game's installs came from India and about 7% from the U.S.– reflecting a common mobile pattern where one region supplies volume and another supplies spend. The design also skewed strongly female: about 63% of players are women.

Crucially, Pizza Ready launched when idle-arcade simulators were trending but offered a fresh twist. Supercent's aggressive user acquisition (testing diverse creatives and playable ads) propelled it up the charts immediately after launch. By mid-2025 the game was still averaging 11–12 million downloads per month, keeping it in the global top-10 charts. The hybrid-casual formula delivered both a huge initial wave and sustained popularity.

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WHAT CAN WE LEARN?

- **Balance simplicity with depth:** Keep the interface and visuals uncluttered, but layer in progression mechanics (multi-queues, upgrades, staff) to engage players long-term.
- **Leverage broad themes:** A universal, non-violent theme (like cooking/pizza) can attract diverse players. Inclusive, creative settings proved especially sticky (Pizza Ready's audience was ~63% female.
- **Add ads seamlessly:** A design analysis highlights a unique twist - instead of generic "rewarded ad" popups, Pizza Ready frames its video rewards as part of the pizza delivery process. The result is a more seamless monetization loop: players feel the ads belong to the gameplay, which can mitigate some of the intrusion. For developers, the lesson is that even if you must run frequent ads, integrating them into the theme (rather than as an ugly paywall) can improve engagement.
- **Hybrid monetization works:** A ~70/30 mix of ads to IAP maximised revenue. Offering compelling purchases (bundles/passes) alongside an ad-driven economy captured both casual players and spenders.
- **Data-driven iteration:** Supercent continually tested creatives, ad networks, and in-game offers by region. This fine-tuning helped sustain millions of daily users and multi-million-dollar monthly revenue.

By early 2025, Pizza Ready had surpassed 200 million installs and remained a top-charting game. It stands as a case study in hybrid-casual success: combining easy-to-play fun with layered progression and creative monetization to achieve both viral reach and enduring engagement.

FINAL TAKEAWAYS

As of mid-2025, Pizza Ready remains a top performer. According to AppMagic data, it was still logging about 11–12 million downloads per month in early 2025, enough to keep it in the global top 10 charts. It recently surpassed 200 million total installs across platforms, underscoring its enduring popularity.

Looking ahead, Supercent has launched industry contests (its 2025 game challenge) to find the next hit, but has not announced new Pizza Ready content beyond small patches.

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Written by: Mariam Ahmad and Josh Vowles

Marketing by: Nisha Fishlock and Alica Parkes

Design by: Jimmy Bridges